



Chloe Cho <chloecho@berkeley.edu>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Harshad Mayekar

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Mon, Jan 25, 2021 at 10:02 PM

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Harshad Mayekar

Gender

Male

Nationality

India

Emailharshadcoevo@gmail.com**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

June 2020

City, state, and country of residence

Mumbai

University education

PhD | Evolutionary Ecology | IISER Thiruvananthapuram | Jan 2013 - June 2020
M.Sc | Life Sciences (Neurobiology) | Sophia College, Mumbai | June 2008 - May 2010
B.Sc | Life Sciences | Ramanarain Ruia College, Mumbai | June 2005 - May 2008

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

I like teaching as this gives us an opportunity to re-learn and understand concepts better. Researchers have a responsibility beyond publishing and that is communicating to masses who do not read scientific literature. Students then are the best targets since an awareness at the school and undergraduate level can inculcate a scientific bent of mind in them. Being a science corp gives us an opportunity both to influence young minds and also strengthen our concepts. Besides, student interactions are ideal for discussing core concepts, looking at new

questions and also innovative solutions. This opportunity would certainly enrich young researchers like me!

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

Teaching assistantships (TA) during my PhD years paved a way to understand student mind-set. I liked interacting with under-graduates and discussing their projects (ecology and evolution) from scratch. The challenge was to assign a project within a time constraint yet retaining student interest to the end. As students have diverse ideas, they love to dabble in a lot of correlated projects. It was at this time that a TA guides them to undertake short, meaningful projects while not limiting a student from developing alternate hypotheses. I enjoyed this journey.

After my PhD, I worked with HBCSE, Mumbai for a brief period. Here, I was involved in the scientific process a student takes to test their hypotheses. Holding regular discussions with students on their projects was a key aspect of this job. The emphasis was to explain ideas to the layman which needs clarity of thought and prediction, crucial in laying the foundations of science. This was followed by discussions on social media which could involve communities worldwide and thus stimulating further discussions into details. Here, I also learnt how multiple biological systems (macro to micro) could be used to address fundamental questions. Example, Predicting seasonal changes by observing flowering, fruiting patterns in neighbourhood trees, growing a microcosm of organisms in a small tank and understanding their biology, nail growth to understand regeneration etc.

Together these experiences put me at an edge to involve more with the student community, in a way strengthening my career goals!

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia
In science education
In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

I am actively looking for post-doctoral experience and want to establish a laboratory (natural sciences) of my own.

CV/Resumé

[HARSHAD-MAYEKAR-CV-converted.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Facebook
Twitter

Any extra comment or message.

I am a diabetic, hence would be careful in giving the final consent if selected.

